

ANCHORS

Hebrews 6:13-20 *“For when God made a promise to Abraham, because He could swear by no one greater, He swore by Himself, 14 saying, “Surely blessing I will bless you, and multiplying I will multiply you.” 15 And so, after he had patiently endured, he obtained the promise. 16 For men indeed swear by the greater, and an oath for confirmation is for them an end of all dispute. 17 Thus God, determining to show more abundantly to the heirs of promise the immutability of His counsel, confirmed it by an oath, 18 that by two immutable things, in which it is impossible for God to lie, we might have strong consolation, who have fled for refuge to lay hold of the hope set before us. 19 Which hope we have as an anchor of the soul, both sure and stedfast, and which entereth into that within the veil.”*

INTRO: Hope enters into the “*THAT*” which is in the veil! The only thing that matters is inside the veil – And that is Jesus!

(TALK ABOUT THE HOLY OF HOLIES – THIS IS WHERE GOD LIVED – ARK OF THE COVENANT - MERCY SEAT – TABLES OF THE LAW – AARONS ROD THAT BUDDERED)

(TALK ABOUT ANCHORS AND HOW THEY WORK)

When an anchor is dropped it goes through the water and fastens itself to the seabed! The solidity at the bottom of the sea moves through the anchor – Through the chain – To the boat – And ultimately to all of us!

The writer of Hebrews declares that our anchor is hope! I am anchored to hope in the:

- Forgiveness that is available through the blood of Jesus...

- Fellowship I have in the body of Christ...
- Fathers loving embrace...
- Word of God...

ANCHORED TO FORGIVENESS

In the Old Testament God spoke in types and shadows to the people who were living in the moment, as well as all of us who would come along at a later time and dispensation. (TALK ABOUT TYPES AND SHADOWS)

One type and shadow is spelled out in the Book of Exodus. It is the account of the death of the firstborn in the land of Egypt. The death angel passed through the land of Egypt and took the life of the firstborn of every house who had not applied the blood of a lamb to their doorway.

Exodus 12:1-4 The Israelites were instructed to:

- Choose a lamb...
- The lamb had to be without blemish...
- The lamb was to be fed the right diet...

- The lamb was to be killed at the appropriate time...
- The blood of the dead lamb was to be painted on the doorway of their houses...
- Prepare the lamb for serving according to God's recipe...
- Eat the flesh of the lamb with their sandals on and their staff in their hand... (EXPLAIN THE SIGNIFICANCE OF THIS)

Until the resurrection of Jesus, this was the most revered event in the history of Israel. It commemorated the night The Israelites came out of Egyptian bondage.

Today we look back to the cross, but in doing so we must go back a few thousand years more, to the event that foreshadowed and prophesied the cross.

What is our purpose for being here today? Is it just to spend a couple of hours together singing songs and hearing a few words from an old

book called a Bible? This is partially true, but our purpose is much greater!

We are here to become more anchored to that which is behind the veil.

In Old Testament worship the High Priest would take the blood of the sacrifice from the altar and go behind the curtain and sprinkle the blood of the sacrifice on the Mercy Seat. The moment of truth of whether or not God would accept the sacrifice was when spotless blood met the presence of God! We are anchored to that which is behind the veil!

(TALK ABOUT THIS AND PUT ON THE HARNESS)

The walk from the altar of sacrifice to the Holy of Holies say's:

- We are here to declare that we are holding to the anchor of the blood of Jesus... Hebrews 9:22 (NKJV) ***“And according to the law almost all things***

are purified with blood, and without shedding of blood there is no remission.” Charles Spurgeon said,
“Morality may keep you out of jail, but it takes the blood of Jesus Christ to keep you out of hell.”

- We are here to continue our move, from death to life – The only way to do this is through the blood... (What can wash away my sin? Nothing but the blood of Jesus)
- We are here to continue our transition from bondage to freedom – The only way to affect real life change is through the blood of Jesus... (Paul- He doth –Hath – And will yet deliver) Jesse Duplantis said, *“The Blood of Jesus washes away our past and the Name of Jesus opens up our future.”*

If my anchor can't move, I can't lose. We are attached to something that can't:

- Be defeated...
- Be altered...
- Be compromised...

How did the Children of Israel get into bondage to start with?

- Story of Joseph...
- There arose a pharaoh who didn't know Joseph... (They went to Egypt a family of 60 something and left a nation of millions – In the worst of times...)
- Egypt was not their home. Israel became slaves to the Egyptians...
- God delivered them by the blood of the lamb...

Fast forward a few thousand years... People today are living in bondage and don't know how they got there or how to get out...

CONCLUSION:

Exodus 12:11-13 (NKJV) *“And thus you shall eat it: with a belt on your waist, your sandals on your feet, and your staff in your hand. So you shall eat it in haste. It is the LORD’S Passover. 12 ‘For I will pass through the land*

of Egypt on that night, and will strike all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and beast; and against all the gods of Egypt, I will execute judgment: I am the LORD. 13 ‘Now the blood shall be a sign for you on the houses where you are. And when I see the blood, I will pass over you; and the plague shall not be on you to destroy you when I strike the land of Egypt.’

- Belt... Finishing touches for the journey (EXPERIENCE IN AIRPORT)
- Sandals... Ready for going the distance
- Staff... Prepared for protection

They were to be prepared - for what God was preparing for them. It is time for us to get anchored to the forgiveness that God has provided, and to get ready for what God has ready for us!

At 11:59 p.m. they were slaves... At 12:00 midnight they were free...

What was the difference between what happened to the Egyptians and the Israelis?

- The Egyptians were shocked by judgment – The Israelis were struck by deliverance!
- The Egyptians were broadsided by loss – The Israelis were stepping into a gateway of a new day...
- The Egyptians were losing their national wealth – The Israelis were collecting on bad debts...
- The Egyptians were planning funerals – The Israelis were planning to celebrate...

What was the difference? The forgiveness provided by the blood that was behind the veil! This forgiveness is horizontal and verticle! ***“If you bring a gift to the altar and discover that your brother has something against you... Leave the gift at the altar – Reconcile with your brother – THEN offer your gift.”***

In the middle of all the instructions concerning the Passover and deliverance from Egypt... these words are given... ***“If the household be too little for the lamb...”*** Notice that the Lamb is NEVER too little for the household... His blood reaches to the highest mountain and flows to the lowest valley!!!

The fact is, there is too much Jesus for just you or your house – We must share the good news of the anchor of forgiveness!

There is no sinner so bad that Jesus cannot save them... ***“Whosoever shall call upon the name of the LORD shall be saved.”*** Charles Spurgeon said, ***“Atonement by the blood of Jesus is not an arm of Christian truth; it is the heart of it.”***

There is no sin so great that Jesus cannot forgive... 1 John 1:9 (AV) ***“If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our***

sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.”

ANCHORED TO THE CHURCH

Matthew 16:13-19 (NKJV) *“When Jesus came into the region of Caesarea Philippi, He asked His disciples, saying, “Who do men say that I, the Son of Man, am?”¹⁴ So they said, “Some say John the Baptist, some Elijah, and others Jeremiah or one of the prophets.”¹⁵ He said to them, “But who do you say that I am?”¹⁶ Simon Peter answered and said, “You are the Christ, the Son of the living God.”¹⁷ Jesus answered and said to him, “Blessed are you, Simon Bar-Jonah, for flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but My Father who is in heaven.¹⁸ “And I also say to you that you are Peter, and on this rock I will build My church, and the gates of Hades shall not prevail against it.¹⁹ “And I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven, and whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven.”*

In this series we are talking about being anchored in our Christian lives. Last week we talked about being anchored to forgiveness through the blood of Jesus. Hebrews 6:19

“Which hope we have as an anchor of the soul, both sure and stedfast, and which entereth into that within the veil.”

(BEHIND THE VEIL IS WHERE GOD LIVED – WHEREVER GOD LIVES IS THE HOUSE OF GOD – WE ARE THE TEMPLE OF THE HOLY GHOST BUT THE LOCAL CHURCH IS WHAT HOLDS THE CORPORATE CHURCH TOGETHER)

This week we are going to talk about being anchored to the church.

Some people ask, do I have to go to church to be a Christian?

- The disciples went to church...
- Jesus went to church...

- We have been commanded in the Word to go to church... (Forsake not the assembling of yourselves together...)

I don't suppose you have to go to church to be a Christian but you don't have to go to a gas station to be a car owner either - but it makes the experience of ownership much more enjoyable. (TRANSMISSION (Midas?) COMMERCIAL – JUST A LITTLE FURTHER ANGEL)

In this passage of Scripture, Jesus makes a bold and forward-thinking prediction concerning the Church He was about to birth. Really, this is the Vision statement for the New Testament Church! Let me hasten on to add that the church is not perfect, far from it, but it is the best thing going! A.W. Tozer said, *“One hundred religious persons knit into a unity by careful organization do not constitute a church any more than eleven dead men make a football team. The first requisite is life, always.”*

Jesus lets us know that what He is predicting is not something which may or may not come to pass; it WILL be fulfilled! “***I will build My church...***” He is going to build His church whether we are a part of it or not. (WHEN YOU FIGHT THE HOUSE – THE HOUSE ALWAYS WINS)

The “***I***” in “***I will build My church***” is the same “***I am***” which sent Moses to Egypt. He is the:

- Eternal one...
- All powerful one...
- Self-existent one...
- All knowing one...
- Omnipresent one...

Jesus, the great “***I Am***” is the architect, founder, builder, supplier and finisher of the Church!

To begin with, no one can build God a church! He is building His own church! Some folks think they are the builder when in fact; we are the material being used in the construction process of the Church! Ephesians 2:19-22 (NKJV) ***“You are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of the household of God, ²⁰having been built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ Himself being the chief cornerstone, ²¹in whom the whole building, being joined together, grows into a holy temple in the Lord, ²²in whom you also are being built together for a dwelling place of God in the Spirit.”***

Duncan Campbell said. *“The Kingdom of God is not going to be advanced by our churches becoming filled with people, but by people in our churches becoming filled with God.”*

Some folks want to own and operate the church! The proprietorship of the Church is not earthly it is Heavenly! (THIS CHURCH IS A THEOCRACY – AND MY NAME IS THEO)

G.K. Chesterson said, *“We do not want, as the newspapers say, a church that will move with the world. We want a church that will move the world.”*

If the ownership of the church is earthly it will fail in complicated times; if it is Heavenly it will succeed without regard to difficulty! Colossians 1:18 (NKJV) ***“He is the head of the body, the church, who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead, that in all things He may have the preeminence.”***

William Temple said, *“The Church is the only society that exists for the benefit of those who are not its members.”*

Many local churches struggle with a strong personality wanting to have ownership in the church. This is not a problem which is unique to our day; it has been going on since the foundation of the Church was initiated. John writes about this in his third letter, verse 9 (NKJV) ***“I wrote to the church, but Diotrephes, who loves to have the preeminence among them, does not receive us.”***

ILLUSTRATION:

Many years ago I was preaching and throughout my sermon I continued to state and restate *“This is not my church; this is not your church; this is God’s church!”*

One lady finally responded by saying, *“This is my church!”* The sad part is, that it was her church, and it failed! Any church owned and operated by man will fail!

Three stages of the Church are clearly seen in Scripture:

- The concept of the Church was initiated in

the age of guilt! Genesis 3:14-15 (NKJV)

“The LORD God said to the serpent:

“Because you have done this, You are cursed more than all cattle, And more than every beast of the field; On your belly you shall go, And you shall eat dust All the days of your life. ¹⁵ And I will put enmity Between you and the woman, And between your seed and her Seed; He shall bruise your head, And you shall bruise His heel.”

Ephesians 1:4 (NKJV) ***“He chose us in Him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy and without blame before Him in love.”***

- The Church is being supernaturally constructed in the Dispensation of Grace! Colossians 3:1-4 (NKJV) ***“If then you were raised with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ is, sitting at the right hand of God. ²Set your mind on things above, not on things on the earth. ³For you died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God. ⁴When Christ who is our***

life appears, then you also will appear with Him in glory.”

- The completion of the Church will occur in the final age! Revelation 21:1-7 (NKJV)
“Now I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away. Also there was no more sea. ²Then I, John, saw the holy city, New Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. ³And I heard a loud voice from heaven saying, “Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and He will dwell with them, and they shall be His people. God Himself will be with them and be their God. ⁴“And God will wipe away every tear from their eyes; there shall be no more death, nor sorrow, nor crying. There shall be no more pain, for the former things have passed away.” ⁵Then He who sat on the throne said, “Behold, I make all things new.” And He said to me, “Write, for these words are true and

faithful.”⁶ And He said to me, “It is done! I am the Alpha and the Omega, the Beginning and the End. I will give of the fountain of the water of life freely to him who thirsts.⁷ “He who overcomes shall inherit all things, and I will be his God and he shall be My son.””

I want to make sure that I am anchored to the church!

CONCLUSION:

Jesus said, *“I will build my Church.”*

- He has...
- He is...
- He will...

My anchor goes deep into the church!

ANCHORED TO THE WORD OF GOD

Matthew 7:24-29 (KJV) *“Therefore, whosoever heareth these sayings of Mine and doeth them, I will liken him unto a wise man,*

*who built his house upon a rock.*²⁵ *And the rain descended and the floods came, and the winds blew and beat upon that house; and it fell not, for it was founded upon a rock.*²⁶ *And every one that heareth these sayings of Mine and doeth them not, shall be likened unto a foolish man, who built his house upon the sand;*²⁷ *and the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house; and it fell, and great was the fall of it.”*²⁸ *And it came to pass, when Jesus had ended these sayings, the people were astonished at His doctrine;*²⁹ *for He taught them as one having authority, and not as the scribes.”*

The last few weeks we have been talking about being anchored to that which is behind the veil... (BEHIND THE VEIL IS WHERE GOD LIVED – THE ARK OF THE COVENANT – THE MERCY SEAT – AARONS ROD THAT BUDDERED – THE TABLES OF THE LAW)

Today I want to talk about being anchored to the Tables Of The Law – Under Grace we are

speaking of the entirety of the Word of God! In this culture if we do not anchor ourselves to the Word of God we will be pushed all over the map by the culture of the world – and - the culture of the church!

If there were ever a time that we as a church need to anchor ourselves to the Word, it's today!

Far too many churches in America are attempting to build its people on recreation, social norms, and entertainment! Any church built on “things” such as this cannot stand!

(HOUSE ON THE SAND VS. HOUSE ON THE ROCK)

Theodore Roosevelt said, *“A thorough knowledge of the Bible is worth more than a college education.”*

Let's take a look at the “word” to see why it's so important to our survival in a hostile culture:

- The Word of God is eternal! Psalm 119:89 (KJV) ***“Forever, O LORD, Thy word is***

settled in heaven.” Isaiah 40:8 (KJV) “The grass withereth, the flower fadeth; but the word of our God shall stand for ever.”

Jesus himself said: Matthew 24:35 (KJV)

“Heaven and earth shall pass away, but My Words shall not pass away.” Can you think of anything more secure upon which to build your life and the church?

- The word of God is food for the soul... Job 23:12 (KJV) *“Neither have I gone back from the commandment of His lips; I have esteemed the words of His mouth more than my necessary food.”* Psalm 119:103 (KJV) *“How sweet are Thy words unto my taste, yea, sweeter than honey to my mouth!”* Jeremiah 15:16 (KJV) *“Thy words were found, and I ate them; and Thy word was unto me the joy and rejoicing of mine heart; for I am called by Thy name, O LORD God of hosts.”*
- The Word of God furnishes a light in the darkness... Psalm 19:8 (KJV) *“The statutes of the LORD are right, rejoicing the heart;*

*the commandment of the LORD is pure,
enlightening the eyes.*” Psalm 119:105

(KJV) **(TURN ALL LIGHTS OFF RIGHT
HERE)** “*Thy word is a lamp unto my feet,
and a light unto my path.*” Psalm 119:130

(KJV) “*The entering of Thy words giveth
light; it giveth understanding unto the*

simple.” 2 Peter 1:19 (KJV) “*We have also
a more sure word of prophecy, unto which
ye do well that ye take heed, as unto a light
that shineth in a dark place, until the day
dawn and the day star arise in your
hearts.*”

- The Word of God purifies the life... Psalm 119:9 (KJV) “*How shall a young man cleanse his way? By taking heed thereto according to Thy word.*” John 15:3 (KJV) “*Now ye are clean through the Word which I have spoken unto you.*” John 17:17 (KJV) “*Sanctify them through Thy truth: Thy Word is truth.*”
- The Word of God is a devouring flame... Jeremiah 5:14 (KJV) “*Therefore, thus saith*

the LORD God of hosts: “Because ye speak this word, behold, I will make My words in thy mouth fire, and this people wood, and it shall devour them.”

- The Word of God is a crushing hammer...
Jeremiah 23:29 (KJV) ***“Is not My word like as a fire?” saith the LORD, “and like a hammer that breaketh the rock in pieces?”***
- The Word of God is a defensive weapon...
Ephesians 6:17 (NKJV) ***“And take the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God;”***
- The Word of God is a probing instrument...
Hebrews 4:12 (KJV) ***“For the Word of God is living and powerful and sharper than any two edged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, and of the joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart.”***
- The Word of God is a life-giving force...
Ezekiel 37:7 (KJV) ***“So I prophesied as I was commanded; and as I prophesied, there was a noise, and behold, a shaking,***

and the bones came together, bone to his bone.”

- The Word of God packs the power to save...
Romans 1:16 (KJV) *“For I am not ashamed of the Gospel of Christ, for it is the power of God unto salvation to every one who believeth, to the Jew first and also to the Greek.”*

Ronald Reagan said, *“Within the covers of the Bible are the answers for all the problems men face.”*

CONCLUSION:

Someone said the word of God will feed the sheep, skin the goats, dehorn the hypocrites, and cut the devil’s head completely off!

The Word is powerful!

We must make every effort to anchor ourselves and this church to that which is behind the veil – The Word of God! We must be anchored to the Word:

- In our marriages...
- In our families...
- In our private devotions...
- In our careers...
- In our singing...
- In our teaching...
- In our preaching...
- In our small groups...
- In our discipleship...

John Locke said, *“The Bible is one of the greatest blessings bestowed by God on the children of men. It has God for its author; salvation for its end, and truth without any mixture for its matter. It is all pure.”*